Wazuh SOC Incident Investigation



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Executive Summary

Beginning on August 10th 2026 and concluding eight days later on August 18th, a simulated attack was detected involving credential compromise on a Windows workstation. After this, the attacker pivoted and attempted to gain access to a Linux server. Automation successfully blocked the attacker at this point; no sensitive data was extracted.

Incident Overview

The first time of detection was on August 10th. A series of six failed logon attempts were made to the Windows user ‘bob’ account on the ‘MYDFIR-Windows’ machine from source IP 192.168.115.131. Initial analysis suggests credential compromise; further investigation into the user's external account history is recommended. After gaining access to this account, the simulated attacker created an unauthorized Guest account seeking further permissions.

The attacker then pivoted to attacking the ‘MYDFIR-Linux’ machine. Containment was achieved on August 18th at 21:51:00 PST when the compromised ‘bob’ account was blocked by automation from an attempted brute force SSH into the Linux machine. The automation rule that blocked the access attempt was rule ID 100101 which pertains to multiple SSH login failures observed from the same source IP. In response, it blocks the attacker’s source IP effectively neutralizing the threat vector.

Technical Findings

A holistic view of the simulated attack can be viewed in Figure 1.

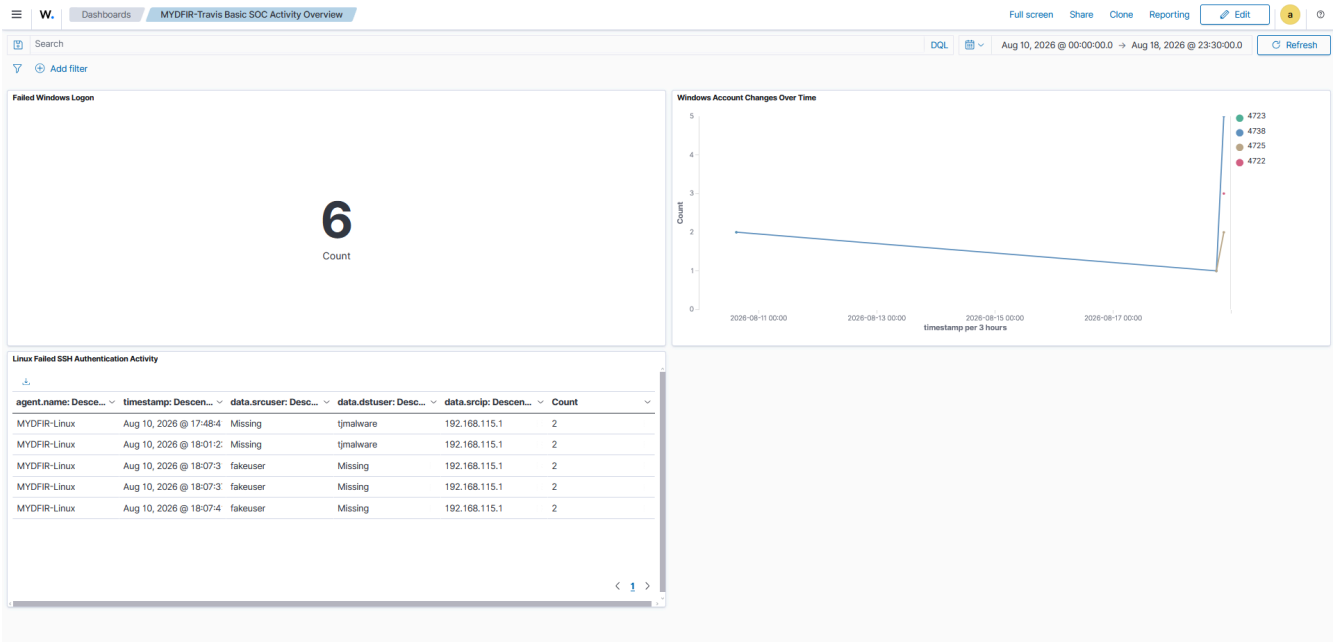
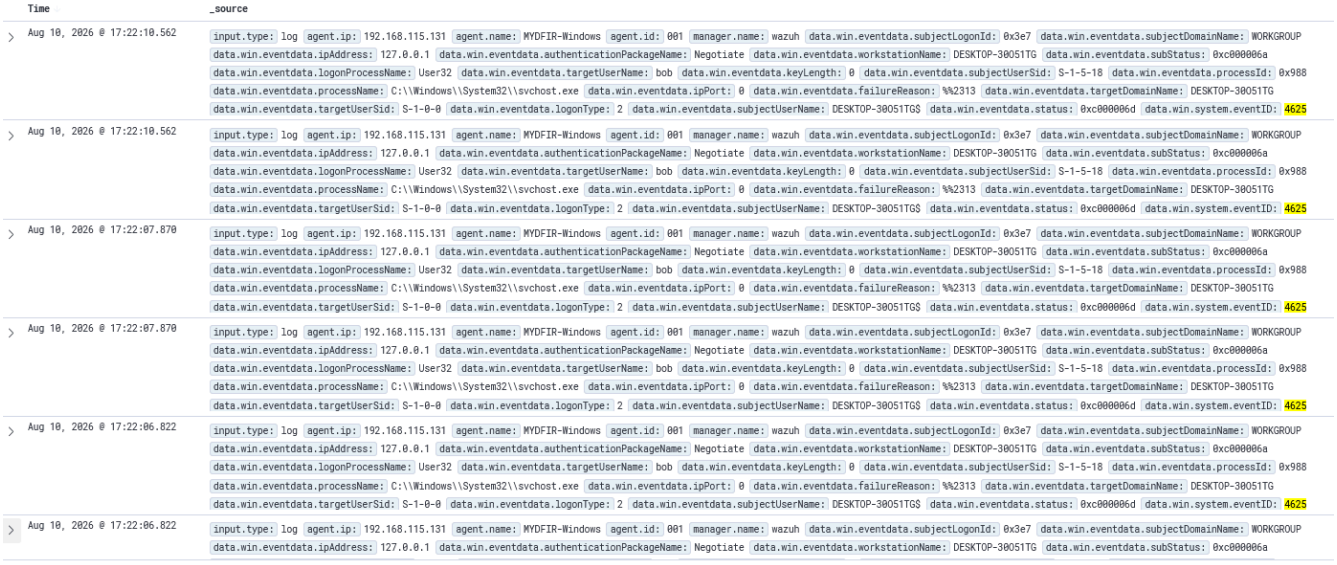


Figure 1: Screenshot of dashboard feed covering 12:00am August 10th 2026 through 11:59pm August 18th 2026

The first indicators of attack are six failed logon attempts (Windows event ID 4625) on the ‘MYDFIR-Windows’ machine by the user ‘bob’. These occurred in rapid succession; all six

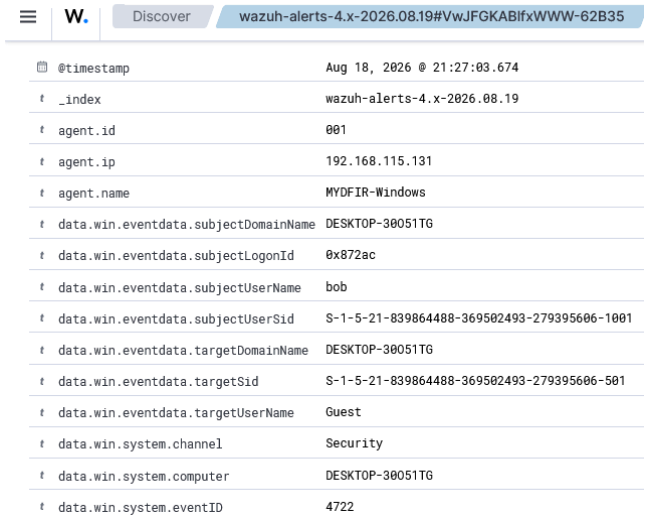
within a four second time-span. This suggests a brute force attempt was made. The small number of total attempts required before a successful logon suggests that the attacker was using a list of breached credentials pertaining to ‘bob’. This user’s external account history should be reviewed to ensure that they are not reusing passwords exposed by external data breaches. These findings can be seen in Figure 2.



Time	_source
Aug 10, 2026 @ 17:22:10.562	input.type: log agent.ip: 192.168.115.131 agent.name: MYDFIR-Windows agent.id: 001 manager.name: wazuh data.win.eventdata.subjectLogonId: 0x3e7 data.win.eventdata.subjectDomainName: WORKGROUP data.win.eventdata.ipAddress: 127.0.0.1 data.win.eventdata.authenticationPackageName: Negotiate data.win.eventdata.workstationName: DESKTOP-30O51TG data.win.eventdata.subStatus: 0xc000006a data.win.eventdata.logonProcessName: User32 data.win.eventdata.targetUserName: bob data.win.eventdata.keyLength: 0 data.win.eventdata.subjectUserSid: S-1-5-18 data.win.eventdata.processId: 0x988 data.win.eventdata.processName: C:\\Windows\\System32\\svchost.exe data.win.eventdata.ipPort: 0 data.win.eventdata.failureReason: %%2313 data.win.eventdata.targetDomainName: DESKTOP-30O51TG data.win.eventdata.targetUserSid: S-1-0-0 data.win.eventdata.logonType: 2 data.win.eventdata.subjectUserName: DESKTOP-30O51TG$ data.win.eventdata.status: 0xc000006d data.win.system.eventID: 4625
Aug 10, 2026 @ 17:22:10.562	input.type: log agent.ip: 192.168.115.131 agent.name: MYDFIR-Windows agent.id: 001 manager.name: wazuh data.win.eventdata.subjectLogonId: 0x3e7 data.win.eventdata.subjectDomainName: WORKGROUP data.win.eventdata.ipAddress: 127.0.0.1 data.win.eventdata.authenticationPackageName: Negotiate data.win.eventdata.workstationName: DESKTOP-30O51TG data.win.eventdata.subStatus: 0xc000006a data.win.eventdata.logonProcessName: User32 data.win.eventdata.targetUserName: bob data.win.eventdata.keyLength: 0 data.win.eventdata.subjectUserSid: S-1-5-18 data.win.eventdata.processId: 0x988 data.win.eventdata.processName: C:\\Windows\\System32\\svchost.exe data.win.eventdata.ipPort: 0 data.win.eventdata.failureReason: %%2313 data.win.eventdata.targetDomainName: DESKTOP-30O51TG data.win.eventdata.targetUserSid: S-1-0-0 data.win.eventdata.logonType: 2 data.win.eventdata.subjectUserName: DESKTOP-30O51TG$ data.win.eventdata.status: 0xc000006d data.win.system.eventID: 4625
Aug 10, 2026 @ 17:22:07.870	input.type: log agent.ip: 192.168.115.131 agent.name: MYDFIR-Windows agent.id: 001 manager.name: wazuh data.win.eventdata.subjectLogonId: 0x3e7 data.win.eventdata.subjectDomainName: WORKGROUP data.win.eventdata.ipAddress: 127.0.0.1 data.win.eventdata.authenticationPackageName: Negotiate data.win.eventdata.workstationName: DESKTOP-30O51TG data.win.eventdata.subStatus: 0xc000006a data.win.eventdata.logonProcessName: User32 data.win.eventdata.targetUserName: bob data.win.eventdata.keyLength: 0 data.win.eventdata.subjectUserSid: S-1-5-18 data.win.eventdata.processId: 0x988 data.win.eventdata.processName: C:\\Windows\\System32\\svchost.exe data.win.eventdata.ipPort: 0 data.win.eventdata.failureReason: %%2313 data.win.eventdata.targetDomainName: DESKTOP-30O51TG data.win.eventdata.targetUserSid: S-1-0-0 data.win.eventdata.logonType: 2 data.win.eventdata.subjectUserName: DESKTOP-30O51TG$ data.win.eventdata.status: 0xc000006d data.win.system.eventID: 4625
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Aug 10, 2026 @ 17:22:06.822	input.type: log agent.ip: 192.168.115.131 agent.name: MYDFIR-Windows agent.id: 001 manager.name: wazuh data.win.eventdata.subjectLogonId: 0x3e7 data.win.eventdata.subjectDomainName: WORKGROUP data.win.eventdata.ipAddress: 127.0.0.1 data.win.eventdata.authenticationPackageName: Negotiate data.win.eventdata.workstationName: DESKTOP-30O51TG data.win.eventdata.subStatus: 0xc000006a data.win.eventdata.logonProcessName: User32 data.win.eventdata.targetUserName: bob data.win.eventdata.keyLength: 0 data.win.eventdata.subjectUserSid: S-1-5-18 data.win.eventdata.processId: 0x988 data.win.eventdata.processName: C:\\Windows\\System32\\svchost.exe data.win.eventdata.ipPort: 0 data.win.eventdata.failureReason: %%2313 data.win.eventdata.targetDomainName: DESKTOP-30O51TG data.win.eventdata.targetUserSid: S-1-0-0 data.win.eventdata.logonType: 2 data.win.eventdata.subjectUserName: DESKTOP-30O51TG$ data.win.eventdata.status: 0xc000006d data.win.system.eventID: 4625
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Figure 2: Query result showing failed logon attempts via event ID 4625.

The next finding of note is a user account being enabled (Windows event ID 4722). The compromised ‘bob’ account on ‘MYDFIR-Windows’ enabled the Guest user account. This is an attack mapped to MITRE T1098 wherein the attacker is attempting to establish persistence. The mechanism of which relies upon the likelihood of Guest accounts to go unnoticed. Additionally, Guest accounts may be left with default permissions which in some cases can be more permissions than a normal user account within the organization is configured for. This finding can be seen in Figure 3.



Discover | wazuh-alerts-4.x-2026.08.19#VwJFGKABIfxWWW-62B35

@timestamp	Aug 18, 2026 @ 21:27:03.674
_index	wazuh-alerts-4.x-2026.08.19
agent.id	001
agent.ip	192.168.115.131
agent.name	MYDFIR-Windows
data.win.eventdata.subjectDomainName	DESKTOP-30O51TG
data.win.eventdata.subjectLogonId	0x872ac
data.win.eventdata.subjectUserName	bob
data.win.eventdata.subjectUserSid	S-1-5-21-839864488-369502493-279395606-1001
data.win.eventdata.targetDomainName	DESKTOP-30O51TG
data.win.eventdata.targetSid	S-1-5-21-839864488-369502493-279395606-501
data.win.eventdata.targetUserName	Guest
data.win.system.channel	Security
data.win.system.computer	DESKTOP-30O51TG
data.win.system.eventID	4722

Figure 3: Log related to activation of Guest account.

After creating the Guest account, the attacker pivoted and attempted to SSH into the ‘MYDFIR-Linux’ Ubuntu server. Three failed SSH attempts were made. This pertains to MITRE technique T1110, brute force. Automation blocked the attacker’s IP in response to rule 100101 triggering; this rule pertains to multiple SSH login failures observed from the same source IP. This isolated the attacker and concluded the security incident. See Figure 4 for the log related to the rule triggering.

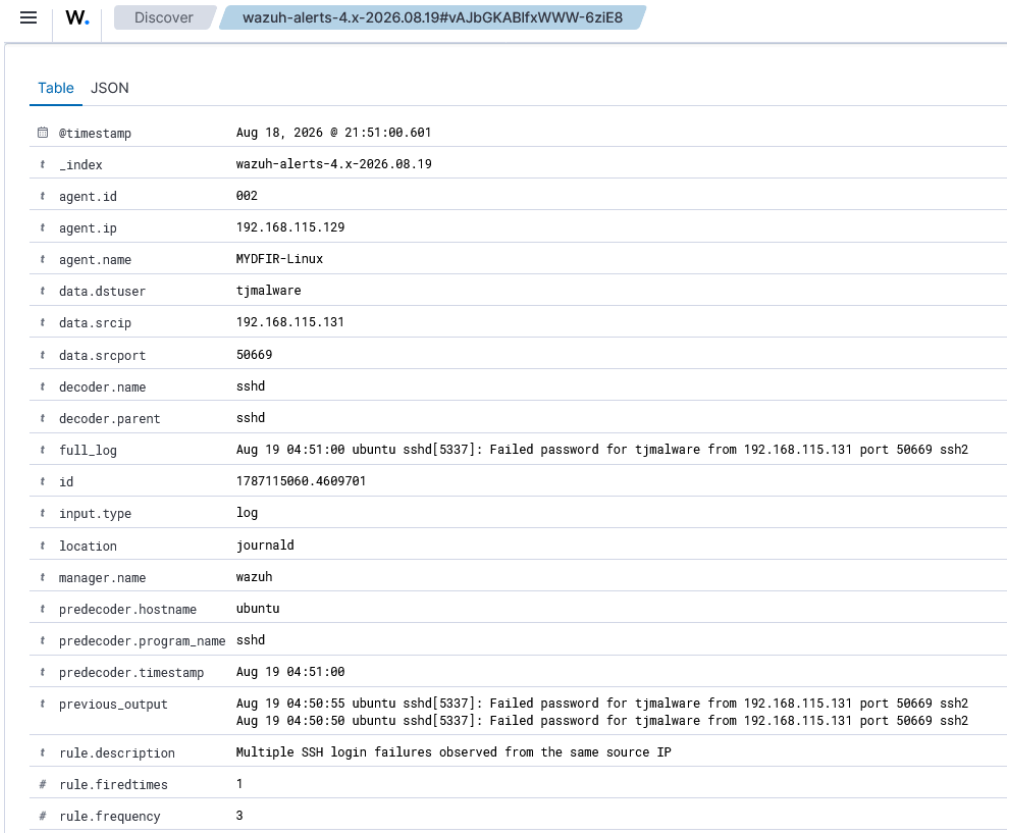


Figure 4: Three failed SSH attempts caused rule 100101 to trigger.

Remediation and Recommendations

An automation rule mirroring rule 100101 should be created for Windows. Multiple event ID 4625 logon failures from a single source IP within a short time span should trigger a firewall block of that IP. The fact that the attacker was able to succeed after six attempts indicates no lockout threshold is in place. An account lockout policy should be implemented on Windows endpoints.

The compromised ‘bob’ account requires an immediate password reset and the user should ensure that they are using a unique password not used on other systems. A review of the user’s breach history is recommended to determine if the password was from a known data breach or if other avenues should be investigated. If breach exposure is discovered, all similarly derived passwords associated with the user should be rotated. MFA should be enforced on all accounts; an MFA policy would have prevented the compromise even with valid credentials.

The unauthorized Guest account should be disabled on the ‘MYDFIR-Windows’ machine and the account creation policy should be updated to disable Guest account creation in the future. There should also be alerting configured for Windows event ID 4722 specifically for Guest accounts so that this activity can be caught more efficiently. Guest account creation should likely be disabled across all machines unless a specific need can be identified.

The ‘MYDFIR-Linux’ server should be configured so that password based SSH authentication is not allowed. Key-based authentication should be the standard. Additionally, SSH exposure should be isolated to management networks or VPNs to minimize exposure. There should be network segmentation present between Windows workstations and servers to limit an attacker’s ability to pivot.

Post-Incident Review

Although no sensitive data was extracted and the attacker was blocked prior to further action, a full review of activities performed on the ‘bob’ account between August 10th and 18th should be conducted to ensure that the Guest account creation was the only persistence mechanism established. The owner of the ‘bob’ account should also receive security awareness training focusing on credential hygiene if it is confirmed that credential reuse was the initial access vector for the incident.